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LIGHT EMITTING DIODE

Abstract

A multi-band light emitting diode is provided. The multi-band light emitting diode includes a first conductivity type semiconductor layer, a V-pit generation layer disposed on the first conductivity type semiconductor layer and having a first V-pit of a first inlet width, a stress relief layer disposed on the V-pit generation layer and providing a second V-pit of a second inlet width greater than the first inlet width of the V-pit on the first V-pit, an active layer disposed on the stress relief layer and including a first active layer region formed on a flat surface of the stress relief layer and a second active layer region formed in the second V-pit, and a second conductivity type semiconductor layer disposed on the active layer.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE OF RELATED APPLICATIONS AND PRIORITY [0001] The present application is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/853,068, filed on Jun. 29, 2022, which is a non-provisional application which claims priority to U.S. Provisional Application Nos. 63/216,910 filed Jun. 30, 2021 and 63/352,838 filed Jun. 16, 2022, the disclosures of which are incorporated by reference as they are fully set forth herein.

TECHNICAL FIELD

[0002] The present disclosure relates to a light emitting diode, and more particularly, to a light emitting diode emitting light of a plurality of bands at a single chip level.

BACKGROUND

[0003] Nitride semiconductors are used as light sources for displaying apparatuses, traffic lights, lighting, or optical communication devices, and may be mainly used for light emitting diodes or laser diodes that emit blue or green light. In addition, nitride semiconductors may be used in a heterojunction bipolar transistor (HBT), a high electron mobility transistor (HEMT), and the like.

[0004] In general, a light emitting diode using the nitride semiconductor has a heterojunction structure having a quantum well structure between an N contact layer and a P contact layer. The light emitting diode emits light of a specific wavelength depending on a composition of a well layer in the quantum well structure. To increase internal quantum efficiency and reduce losses due to light absorption, the light emitting diode is designed to emit a spectrum of light having a single peak, i.e., monochromatic light.

[0005] Mixed color light emitted from lighting, for example, white light cannot be implemented as a single peak monochromatic light. Accordingly, techniques of implementing white light by using a plurality of light emitting diodes together emitting different monochromatic lights from one another or by using phosphors converting a wavelength of light emitted from the light emitting diode is generally used.

[0006] The use of phosphors comes with cost of the phosphors or a decrease in efficiency known as Stoke's shift. In addition, a process of applying phosphors on the light emitting diode and yellowing of a carrier carrying phosphors should be taken into consideration.

[0007] In addition, using a mixture of a plurality of light emitting diodes also complicates the process, and it is inconvenient to prepare the light emitting diodes made of different materials from one another.

[0008] When a light emitting diode emitting light of a plurality of bands at a single chip level is used, a plurality of light emitting diodes made of different materials can be avoided, and the use of a phosphor may be eliminated or at least reduced.

SUMMARY

[0009] Exemplary embodiments provide a novel light emitting diode configured to emit light of a plurality of bands at a single chip level.

[0010] Exemplary embodiments provide a novel technique capable of increasing an intensity of light of a shorter wavelength band in a light emitting diode of a plurality of bands.

[0011] Exemplary embodiments provide a multi-band light emitting diode in which an intensity of a shorter wavelength band is further increased compared to that of a longer wavelength band.

[0012] A light emitting diode according to an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure

includes a first conductivity type semiconductor layer, a V-pit generation layer disposed on the first conductivity type semiconductor layer and having a first V-pit of a first inlet width, a stress relief layer disposed on the V-pit generation layer and providing a second V-pit of a second inlet width greater than the first inlet width of the V-pit on the first V-pit, an active layer disposed on the stress relief layer and including a first active layer region formed on a flat surface of the stress relief layer and a second active layer region formed in the second V-pit, and a second conductivity type semiconductor layer disposed on the active layer.

[0013] The stress relief layer may include an $\text{In}_{0.2}\text{Al}_{0.8}\text{Ga}_{0.1}\text{N}_{0.9}$ layer ($0 < x < 1$, $0 \leq y < 1$), and an average lattice constant of the stress relief layer may be greater than an average lattice constant of the V-pit generation layer and smaller than an average lattice constant of the active layer.

[0014] The stress relief layer may include a plurality of pairs of different nitride semiconductor layers.

[0015] The stress relief layer may have a stacked structure in which nitride semiconductor layers having different band gap energies are alternately disposed.

[0016] The stress relief layer may include a superlattice layer.

[0017] The superlattice layer may be an InGaN/GaN superlattice layer.

[0018] In an exemplary embodiment, a number of pairs of the stress relief layer may be greater than a number of pairs of a barrier layer and a well layer of the active layer.

[0019] The number of pairs of the stress relief layer may be 6 to 20.

[0020] The light emitting diode may further include a gap layer disposed between the stress relief layer and the active layer, in which the gap layer may have a lattice constant smaller than the average lattice constant of the stress relief layer and the average lattice constant of the active layer. The gap layer may include a GaN layer.

[0021] A light emitting diode according to an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure includes a first conductivity type semiconductor layer, a V-pit generation layer having V-pits; a stress relief layer disposed on the V-pit generation layer, an active layer disposed on the stress relief layer, and a second conductivity type semiconductor layer disposed on the active layer. The light emitting diode emits light of a multi-band spectrum of a shorter wavelength band and a longer wavelength band, and under an operating current, an intensity of light of the shorter wavelength band is higher than an intensity of light of the longer wavelength band.

[0022] In the light emitting diode, the intensity of light in the shorter wavelength band may be two or more times higher than that of light in the longer wavelength band.

[0023] In the light emitting diode, the intensity of light in the shorter wavelength band may be three or more times higher than that of light in the longer wavelength band.

[0024] The stress relief layer may be a superlattice layer having a plurality of pairs.

[0025] The number of pairs of the stress relief layer may be within a range of 6 to 20.

[0026] The number of pairs of the stress relief layer may be greater than that of pairs of a well layer and a barrier layer of the active layer.

[0027] The superlattice layer may be an InGaN/GaN superlattice layer.

[0028] A peak wavelength of light in the shorter wavelength band may be within a range of 380 nm to 450 nm, and a peak wavelength of light in the longer wavelength band may be within a range of 540 nm to 580 nm.

[0029] The stress relief layer may include an $\text{In}_{0.2}\text{Al}_{0.8}\text{Ga}_{0.1}\text{N}_{0.9}$ layer ($0 < x < 1$, $0 \leq y < 1$), and an average lattice constant of the stress relief layer may be greater than an average lattice constant of the V-pit generation layer and smaller than an average lattice constant of the active layer.

[0030] The second conductivity type semiconductor layer may have concave grooves formed on a surface thereof, and an inlet width of at least one of the concave grooves may exceed 400 nm.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF DRAWINGS

[0031] FIG. 1 is a schematic cross-sectional view illustrating a light emitting diode according to an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0032] FIG. 2 is a partially enlarged view of FIG. 1.

[0033] FIG. 3A is a Cathodoluminescence (CL) image showing a surface of a light emitting diode according to a prior art.

[0034] FIG. 3B is a CL image showing a surface of a light emitting diode according to an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0035] FIG. 4 is a graph showing an Electroluminescence (EL) spectrum according to an increase in a number of pairs of a stress relief layer.

[0036] FIG. 5A is a secondary ion mass spectrometry (SIMS) analysis graph of a light emitting diode according to the prior art.

[0037] FIG. 5B is a SIMS analysis graph of a light emitting diode according to an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF EMBODIMENTS

[0038] Hereinafter, exemplary embodiments of the present disclosure will be described in detail with reference to the accompanying drawings. The following embodiments are provided by way of example so as to fully convey the spirit of the present disclosure to those skilled in the art to which the present disclosure pertains. Accordingly, the present disclosure is not limited to the exemplary embodiments disclosed herein and can also be implemented in different forms. In the drawings, widths, lengths, thicknesses, and the like of elements can be exaggerated for clarity and descriptive purposes. When an element or layer is referred to as being “disposed above” or “disposed on” another element or layer, it can be directly “disposed above” or “disposed on” the other element or layer or intervening elements or layers can be present. Throughout the specification, like reference numerals denote like elements having the same or similar functions.

[0039] FIG. 1 is a schematic cross-sectional view illustrating a light emitting diode **100** according to an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure, and FIG. 2 is a partially enlarged view of FIG. 1.

[0040] Referring to FIG. 1 and FIG. 2, the light emitting diode **100** may include a substrate **21**, a first conductivity type semiconductor layer **23**, a V-pit generation layer **25**, a stress relief layer **27**, a gap layer **29**, an active layer **31**, an electron blocking layer **33**, and a second conductivity type semiconductor layer **35**.

[0041] The substrate **21** is for growing a gallium nitride-based semiconductor layer, and may include a sapphire substrate, a GaN substrate, a SiC substrate, a Si substrate, a spinel substrate, or the like. The substrate **21** may have protrusions, and may be, for example, a patterned sapphire substrate. However, the inventive concepts are not limited thereto, and may be a substrate having a flat upper surface, for example, a sapphire substrate.

[0042] The first conductivity type semiconductor layer **23** may be a nitride-based semiconductor layer doped with an n-type impurity, and may be formed of, for example, a GaN layer doped with Si. For example, a Si doping concentration doped into the first conductivity type semiconductor layer **23** may be $5 \times 10^{17}/\text{cm}^2$ to $5 \times 10^{19}/\text{cm}^2$. The first conductivity type semiconductor layer **23** may be grown under a growth pressure of 150 Torr to 200 Torr at 1000° C. to 1200° C. (e.g., 1050° C. to 1100° C.) by supplying a metal source gas into a chamber using MOCVD technology. In this case, a nucleation layer and a high-temperature buffer layer may be additionally formed so as to grow the first conductivity type semiconductor layer **23**. That is, the nucleation layer, the high-temperature buffer layer, and the first conductivity type semiconductor layer **23** may be continuously formed on the substrate **21**. A large number of threading dislocations

may be formed in the high-temperature buffer layer, and at least portions of the threading dislocations in the high-temperature buffer layer may be transferred to the first conductivity type semiconductor layer **23**. Threading dislocations **23a** in the first conductivity type semiconductor layer **23** may extend from a lower surface to an upper surface of the first conductivity type semiconductor layer **23**.

[0043] The V-pit generation layer **25** is disposed over the first conductivity type semiconductor layer **23**. In an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure, the V-pit generation layer **25** may be formed of, for example, a GaN layer. The V-pit generation layer **25** may be grown at a relatively lower temperature than that for growing the first conductivity type semiconductor layer **23**, for example, about 900° C., and thus, V-pits **25a** are formed in the V-pit generation layer **25**.

[0044] Since the V-pit generation layer **25** is grown at the relatively lower temperature than that for growing the first conductivity type semiconductor layer **23**, a crystal quality may be artificially reduced and a three-dimensional growth may be promoted to generate the V-pits **25a**.

[0045] The V-pits **25a** may have a hexagonal pyramid shape when a growth surface of the nitride semiconductor layer is a c-plane. The V-pits **25a** may be formed at upper ends of the threading dislocations **23a**.

[0046] The V-pit generation layer **25** may be formed to have a thickness smaller than that of the first conductivity type semiconductor layer **23**, for example, to have a thickness of about 450 nm to about 600 nm. Sizes of the V-pits **25a** formed in the V-pit generation layer **25** may be controlled through a growth condition and a growth time of the V-pit generation layer **25**. In an exemplary embodiment, a maximum width of an inlet of the V-pits **25a** formed in the V-pit generation layer **25** may generally exceed about 200 nm, and may be about 350 nm or less. The size of the V-pit **25a** is related to a total volume of an active layer region **31b** formed in the V-pit **25a**. As the size the V-pit **25a** increases, the total volume of the active layer region **31b** increases, thereby increasing an amount of light in a shorter wavelength band. When the size of the V-pit **25a** is excessively small, the total volume of the active layer region **31b** becomes small, and thus, it is difficult to increase the amount of light in the shorter wavelength band.

[0047] The thickness of the V-pit generation layer **25** affects the size of the V-pit **25a**. To form the V-pit **25a** large, the thickness of the V-pit generation layer **25** increases. However, since the V-pit generation layer **25** has a smaller lattice constant than that of the active layer **31**, an increase in the thickness of the V-pit generation layer **25** results in an increase in stress applied to the active layer **31**. The thickness of the V-pit generation layer **25** may be limited in consideration of the stress applied to the active layer **31**. That is, there is a trade-off relationship between an increase in the volume of the active layer region **31b** through the increase in the size of the V-pit **25a** and the stress applied to the active layer **31**.

[0048] In the illustrated exemplary embodiment, although it is described that the V-pit generation layer **25** is a single layer, without being limited thereto, and it may be a multilayer. For example, the V-pit generation layer **25** may include at least two of GaN, AlGaIn, InGaIn, or AlGaInN layers.

[0049] The stress relief layer **27** may be disposed on the V-pit generation layer **25**, and may be grown along the shape of the V-pit **25a** formed in the V-pit generation layer **25**. The stress relief layer **27** may include a plurality of nitride semiconductor layers, and for example, may include a superlattice layer (SLs) formed by repeatedly stacking materials having different energy band gaps multiple times. The stress relief layer **27** may be grown along the shape of the V-pit **25a** formed in the V-pit generation layer **25**, and may include a nitride semiconductor layer such as

In.sub.xAl.sub.yGa.sub.1-x-y N (0<x<1, 0≤y<1).

[0050] The stress relief layer **27** is disposed between the V-pit generation layer **25** and the active layer **31** to relieve the stress applied to the active layer **31**. An average lattice constant of the stress relief layer **27** may have a value between an average lattice constant of the V-pit generation layer **25** and an average lattice constant of the active layer **31**. By way of example only, the average lattice constant of the stress relief layer **27** ranges between 3.2 Å and 3.25 Å. As another example,

the average lattice constant of the V-pit generation layer **25** is under 3.2 Å and the average lattice constant of the active layer **31** is over 3.25 Å. For example, the stress relief layer **27** may be a superlattice layer including a plurality of InGaN/GaN pairs. Herein, a composition ratio of In in the InGaN of the stress relief layer **27** may be smaller than that of In in a well layer of the active layer **31**.

[0051] By increasing a thickness of the stress relief layer **27**, an inlet width of a V-pit **27a** formed on an upper surface of the stress relief layer **27** may be increased. For example, by increasing the number of InGaN/GaN pairs in the superlattice layer of the stress relief layer **27**, the inlet width of the V-pit **27a** finally formed on the upper surface of the stress relief layer **27** may be increased. As discussed above, a number of pairs of nitride semiconductor layers included in the superlattice layer may be, for example, three (3) or more pairs, and further may be within the range of six (6) to twelve (12). Also, the number of pairs of the superlattice layer may be greater than the number of pairs of a barrier layer and a well layer in the active layer **31**. Accordingly, while the stress applied to the active layer **31** is relieved, the volume of the active layer region **31b** may be increased, and as a result, a luminous intensity of the shorter wavelength band may be relatively increased. In addition, by using the stress relief layer **27**, a crystal quality of the active layer **31** may be improved, and thus, an internal quantum efficiency may be also improved in the active layer region **31a**.

[0052] The stress relief layer **27** may include the same doped impurity as that of the first conductivity type semiconductor layer **23**. The stress relief layer **27** may serve to relieve strain formed during a growth of the nitride semiconductor layer, thereby improving the crystal quality of the active layer **31** to increase a radiation efficiency of the light emitting diode.

[0053] The gap layer **29** is disposed between the active layer **31** and the stress relief layer **27**. A lattice constant of the gap layer **29** may be smaller than the average lattice constant of the stress relief layer **27**, and may be smaller than the average lattice constant of the active layer **31**. The gap layer **29** may be a nitride-based semiconductor layer having the same composition as that of the barrier layer of the active layer **31** or any one layer in the stress relief layer **27**, but the inventive concepts are not limited thereto. The gap layer **29** may be, for example, a GaN layer. A thickness of the gap layer **29** may be greater than a thickness of the barrier layer in the active layer **31**, without being limited thereto. The gap layer **29** may be grown along a shape of the stress relief layer **27**. The gap layer **29** may be omitted, and the active layer **31** may be directly grown on the stress relief layer **27**.

[0054] The active layer **31** is formed on the stress relief layer **27**. The active layer **31** may be in contact with the stress relief layer **27**, but as described above, the gap layer **29** may be interposed between the stress relief layer **27** and the active layer **31**. The active layer **31** may be formed along the shape of the V-pit **27a** formed on a surface of the stress relief layer **27**. The active layer **31** includes the active layer region **31a** formed over a flat surface of the V-pit generation layer **25** and the active layer region **31b** formed in the V-pit **27a**, as shown in FIG. 1. A thickness of the active layer region **31b** formed in the V-pit **27a** is smaller than that of the active layer region **31a** formed over the flat surface of the V-pit generation layer **25**. The thickness of the active layer region **31b** in the V-pit **27a** may vary according to a depth of the V-pit **27a**. The thickness of the active layer region **31b** at an intermediate depth of the V-pit **27a** may be about $\frac{1}{3}$ or less of the thickness of the active layer region **31a** formed over the flat surface of the V-pit generation layer **25**. In particular, a thickness of a well layer at the intermediate depth of the V-pit **27a** may be about $\frac{1}{3}$ or less of a thickness of a well layer formed over the flat surface of the V-pit generation layer **25**.

[0055] The well layer in the active layer **31** may be formed of $\text{In}_{\text{sub.x}}\text{Al}_{\text{sub.y}}\text{Ga}_{\text{sub.1-x-y}}\text{N}$ ($0 < x < 1$, $0 \leq y < 1$). Composition ratios of In, Al, and Ga may be selected depending on a required light. The active layer region **31a** formed over the flat surface of the V-pit generation layer **25** has a composition for emitting light of a longer wavelength band among multi-bands. Meanwhile, the active layer region **31b** formed in the V-pit **27a** has a composition for emitting light of a shorter

wavelength band among multi-bands. For example, the composition ratio of In in the active layer region **31a** is higher than that of In in the active layer region **31b**. The active layer region **31a** may include InGa_N having a composition emitting yellow light, and the active layer region **31b** may include InGa_N having a composition emitting green or blue light.

[0056] The active layer region **31b** may be formed with the same composition on each surface in the V-pit **27a**, without being limited thereto, and may be formed on each surface with a different composition from one another. The light emitting diode **100** of the present disclosure may implement light having at least two bands at a single chip level using the active layer region **31a** and the active layer region **31b**.

[0057] The barrier layer may be formed of a nitride semiconductor layer such as GaN, InGa_N, AlGa_N, or AlInGa_N having a wider bandgap than that of the well layer. For example, when the active layer region **31a** includes an InGa_N well layer emitting yellow light, the barrier layer may be formed of InGa_N or InAlGa_N having a lower content of In than that of the well layer. The thickness of the well layer may be within a range of 2.5 nm to 3.5 nm, and the thickness of the barrier layer may be within a range of 10 nm to 12 nm.

[0058] The active layer **31** may further include a capping layer between the well layer and the barrier layer. The capping layer may be formed prior to barrier layer deposition so as to prevent dissociation of In in the well layer during a barrier layer deposition.

[0059] The light emitting diode **100** of the present disclosure may emit white light by mixing light of the longer wavelength band emitted from the active layer region **31a** and light of the shorter wavelength band emitted from the active layer region **31b**.

[0060] The second conductivity type semiconductor layer **35** is disposed on the active layer **31**. The electron blocking layer **33** may be disposed between the second conductivity type semiconductor layer **35** and the active layer **31**. The electron blocking layer **33** may include a p-type Al_{sub.x}Ga_{sub.1-x}N layer ($0 < x < 1$).

[0061] The second conductivity type semiconductor layer **35** may be formed of a semiconductor layer doped with a p-type impurity, for example, GaN. The second conductivity type semiconductor layer **35** may be a single layer or a multilayer, and may include a p-type contact layer. As shown in FIG. **1**, the second conductivity type semiconductor layer **35** may have a concave groove **35a** over the V-pit **25a**. Since the concave groove **35a** is formed in the second conductivity type semiconductor layer **35** in the illustrated exemplary embodiment, when light generated in the active layer region **31b** is emitted to the outside through the second conductivity type semiconductor layer **35**, it is possible to reduce light absorption by the second conductivity type semiconductor layer **35**, and thus, light extraction efficiency may be improved.

[0062] According to the exemplary embodiments of the present disclosure, the light emitting diode emitting light of a plurality of bands using the V-pits **25a** and **27a** is disclosed. The active layer region **31b** formed in the V-pit **27a** emits light of the shorter wavelength band, the active layer region **31a** formed on the flat surface around the V-pit **27a** emits light of the longer wavelength band, and it is possible to implement white light due to a combination of these light.

[0063] A light emitting diode using conventional V-pits has a relatively weak intensity of light in the shorter wavelength band, and thus, it was difficult to implement white light having a high color temperature. In particular, a well layer having a high content of In is used so as to emit light in a longer wavelength band, and large stress may be generated in an active layer having the high content of In due to a large lattice mismatch between epitaxial layers. The stress applied to the active layer causes internal defects in the active layer, and indium phase separation occurs. The internal defects and the indium phase separation lower a radiative recombination efficiency in the active layer, and thus, a radiation efficiency is lowered.

[0064] Meanwhile, the light emitting diode **100** of the present disclosure reduces the stress applied to the active layer **31** by using the stress relief layer **27** and further, increases the volume of the active layer region **31b** formed in the V-pit **27a** using the stress relief layer **27**. Accordingly, the

radiation efficiency of the light emitting diode **100** may be increased, and the intensity of light in the shorter wavelength band emitted from the active layer region **31b** may also be greatly increased.

[0065] FIG. **3A** is a Cathodoluminescence (CL) image showing a surface of a light emitting diode according to the prior art, and FIG. **3B** is a CL image showing a surface of a light emitting diode according to an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure. FIG. **3A** and FIG. **3B** show sizes of the images at the same magnification, which are enlarged images, respectively.

[0066] FIG. **3A** shows a surface of a second conductivity type semiconductor layer of a light emitting diode fabricated without a stress relief layer such as the stress relief layer **27**, and FIG. **3B** shows a surface of the second conductivity type semiconductor layer **35** of the light emitting diode to which the stress relief layer **27** formed on the V-pit generation layer **25** is added according to the present disclosure. Concave grooves **35a** formed over V-pits **25a** of the V-pit generation layer **25** are shown in each image. Except for the presence or absence of the stress relief layer **27**, the light emitting diodes of FIG. **3A** and FIG. **3B** have the same structure.

[0067] As shown in FIG. **3A**, an inlet width of the concave grooves formed on the surface of the second conductivity type semiconductor layer has a size of approximately 314 nm to 330 nm. On the contrary, as shown in FIG. **3B**, by adding the stress relief layer **27**, an inlet width of the concave grooves formed on the surface of the second conductivity type semiconductor layer has a size of approximately 390 nm to 440 nm. The sizes of the concave grooves **35a** formed on the surface of the second conductivity type semiconductor layer **35** were increased by approximately 70 nm to 110 nm by the addition of the stress relief layer **27**. A size of the V-pit **27a** formed on the surface of the stress relief layer **27** will be further increased by increasing a thickness of the stress relief layer **27**.

[0068] FIG. **4** is a graph showing an Electroluminescence (EL) spectrum according to an increase in a number of pairs of the stress relief layer. Other conditions were set to be identical, except that the number of InGaN/GaN pairs of the stress relief layer **27** was changed to 3, 6, 9, and 12 to fabricate the light emitting diode, and the number of pairs of a barrier layer and a well layer of an active layer **31** was set to five (5). A thickness of the InGaN/GaN of the stress relief layer **27** was about 3 μm /5.8 μm . A composition ratio of In of InGaN was within a range of about 0.07 to 0.1, which was $\frac{1}{2}$ or less than a composition ratio of In of about 0.2 of the well layer. An emission spectrum was measured under a current density of 35 A/cm.^{sup.2}

[0069] Referring to FIG. **4**, as the number of pairs of the stress relief layer **27** was increased, an intensity of light emitted in a shorter wavelength band (about 380 to about 450 nm) was increased. In particular, when the number of pairs of the stress relief layer **27** is six (6), which is more than five (5) pairs of the active layer **31**, an intensity of light at a peak wavelength of the shorter wavelength band exceeded twice of an intensity of light at a peak wavelength of a longer wavelength band (about 540 to about 580 nm). As the number of pairs of the stress relief layer **27** was increased to nine (9), the intensity of light at the peak wavelength of the shorter wavelength band exceeded 4 times the intensity of light at the peak wavelength of the longer wavelength band, and when the number of pairs was increased to twelve (12), the intensity of light at the peak wavelength of the shorter wavelength band exceeded 5 times the intensity of light at the peak wavelength of the longer wavelength band. When the number of pairs was increased from six (6) to nine (9) compared to when the number of pairs was increased from three (3) to six (6), the intensity of light in the shorter wavelength band exhibited larger. On the contrary, when the number of pairs was increased from nine (9) to twelve (12), the increase in the intensity of light in the shorter wavelength band was relatively small. As such, the increase in the intensity of light in the shorter wavelength band is expected to be saturated as the number of pairs is increased, and thus, an appropriate number of pairs will be less than 20.

[0070] A size of the V-pit **27a** formed on the surface of the stress relief layer **27** will be increased as the number of pairs of the stress relief layer **27** is increased, and thus, a total volume of the active

layer region **31b** formed in the V-pit **27a** will be increased. As such, as the thickness of the stress relief layer **27** is increased, the total volume of the active layer region **31b** is increased and thus, it can be seen that the intensity of light in the shorter wavelength band is increased compared to that of light in the longer wavelength band. In addition, since a total volume of an active layer region **31a** emitting light in the longer wavelength band is relatively reduced, it can be expected that the intensity of light in the longer wavelength band is decreased. However, an internal quantum efficiency is increased due to an improvement of a crystal quality of the active layer region **31a**, and accordingly, it seems that the intensity of light in the longer wavelength band is relatively decreased.

[0071] Meanwhile, it can be seen that in the relatively larger V-pit **27a**, more various thicknesses of the active layer region **31b** and more various InGa_N compositions may be disposed and thus, it can be seen that a wavelength range of light emitted in the shorter wavelength band becomes wider. On the contrary, in the longer wavelength band, a wavelength range of emitted light may be narrower as the crystal quality of the active layer region **31a** is improved.

[0072] Furthermore, as shown in FIG. 4, as the number of pairs of the stress relief layer **27** is increased, the peak wavelength of the longer wavelength band is shifted to the right. Since the well layer of the active layer **31** has a high content of In, an indium phase separation may easily occur in the well layer due to the applied stress. As the thickness of the stress relief layer **27** is increased, the stress applied to the well layer is reduced to prevent the indium phase separation, so it is considered that the peak wavelength of the longer wavelength band is shifted to the longer wavelength. That is, it can be seen that the content of In in the InGa_N well layer is increased by increasing the thickness of the stress relief layer **27**.

[0073] When an intensity ratio of the exemplary embodiment implemented in FIG. 4 is expressed in the following table. An intensity ratio (shorter wavelength:longer wavelength) according to a ratio of the number of pairs of the stress relief layer based on the number of pairs of an active layer is as follows. When the number of pairs of the stress relief layer is equal to or greater than 1.2 times that of the active layer, the V-pit expands, and thus, it is possible to implement white light. In addition, since the intensity ratio of the shorter wavelength, which is light generated from the V-pit, is two times or more than that of the longer wavelength, it is possible to effectively implement white light.

TABLE-US-00001 Pair Intensity Ratio Ratio (shorter wavelength: (SLs:MQW) longer wavelength)
Comparative Example 1 0.6:1 0.25:0.90 (0.3:1) Experimental Example 1 1.2:1 1.50:0.75 (2.0:1)
Experimental Example 2 1.8:1 3.20:0.70 (4.5:1) Experimental Example 3 2.4:1 3.70:0.60 (6.2:1)

[0074] An intensity ratio depending on a thickness ratio of the stress relief layer based on the thickness of the active layer is as follows. When the thickness of the stress relief layer is equal to or greater than 0.6 times that of the active layer, the V-pit expands, and it is possible to implement white light. In addition, since the intensity of the shorter wavelength of light, which is generated from the V-pit, is two times or more than that of the longer wavelength, it is possible to effectively implement white light.

TABLE-US-00002 Thickness Intensity ratio ratio (shorter wavelength: (SLs:MQW) longer wavelength)
Comparative Example 1 0.3~0.4:1 0.25:0.90 (0.3:1) Experimental Example 1 0.6~0.9:1 1.50:0.75 (2.0:1)
Experimental Example 2 1.0~1.3:1 3.20:0.70 (4.5:1) Experimental Example 3 1.35~1.7:1 3.70:0.60 (6.2:1)

[0075] FIG. 5A is a secondary ion mass spectrometry (SIMS) analysis graph of a light emitting diode (Comparative Example) according to the prior art, and FIG. 5B is a SIMS analysis graph of a light emitting diode (Inventive Example) according to an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0076] Referring to FIG. 5A and FIG. 5B, as the Comparative Example does not include the stress relief layer **27**, a size of the V-pit is not large, and thus, a shape of an active layer (MQW) is observed as shown in FIG. 5A. On the contrary, in the light emitting diode of the Inventive

Example in which the stress relief layer 27 (SLs) were added, the same active layer (MQW) as that of the Comparative Example was formed, but a slope of an In composition was so gentle that it was impossible to distinguish a well layer from a barrier layer of the active layer as shown in FIG. 5B. This is due to an increase in a region occupied by the V-pits within a beam size for SIMS analysis as the sizes of the V-pits are increased. That is, since a flat region and the V-pit region have a similar size, or the V-pit region exists in a larger size, during an etching by a SIMS analysis equipment, secondary ions emitted from the flat region and secondary ions emitted in the V-pit are mixed, which makes it impossible to distinguish a boundary between each layer.

[0077] Meanwhile, as arbitrarily indicated in FIG. 5B, the region of the active layer (MQW) includes a greater content of In than the region of the stress relief layer (SLs). An intensity of the secondary ions of In may have a profile that is an upward convex curve and decreases in a direction closer to a first conductivity type semiconductor layer with respect to the active layer. That is, in the region of D1 toward the intersecting point, a slope of the convex curve where an amount of In is decreased is gradually getting steeper.

[0078] Referring to FIG. 5A and FIG. 5B, the intensity of the secondary ions of In may be superimposed on a location where a concentration profile of Si is formed, and the intensity of the secondary ions of In may be gradually decreased toward the first conductivity type semiconductor layer to cross a base level, and reaches a base level of In, $1\text{E}+03$ count/sec. That is, it is possible to predict the size of the V-pit according to how much depth the intensity of the secondary ions of In is formed at $1\text{E}+03$ count/sec or more. Based on an intersection point where the intensity of the secondary ions of In and the base level cross, assuming that a distance from the intersection point to a peak point where an intensity of secondary ions of Al is the highest is called D1, and a distance from the intersection point of In to the first conductivity type semiconductor layer, that is, a distance from the concentration profile of Si to an approximately middle of a portion where the concentration of Si increases rapidly is called D2, it is possible to make the location of the intersection point of In with the base level closer to the first conductivity type semiconductor layer by expanding the volume of the V-pit through the exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure. D2 may be configured to be smaller than D1, and since the volume of the V-pit is expanded to get closer to the first conductivity type semiconductor layer, electron injection may be facilitated through the expanded V-pit, and white light may be implemented in a semiconductor device.

[0079] An In concentration profile in the D1 region may have a form in which an absolute value of the slope increases. That is, it may be a form in which the In concentration is rapidly reduced or a form in which the band gap energy is rapidly reduced. In addition, it may have a convex profile in a direction of the first conductivity type semiconductor layer.

[0080] Light generated from the light emitting diode may be emitted through the first conductivity type semiconductor layer or the second conductivity type semiconductor layer, and light emitted in this case may be white light.

[0081] While particular embodiments and aspects of the present disclosure have been illustrated and described herein, various other changes and modifications can be made without departing from the spirit and scope of the disclosure. Moreover, although various aspects have been described herein, such aspects need not be utilized in combination. In addition, elements described in an embodiment may be applied to other embodiments without departing from the spirit of the present disclosure. Accordingly, it is therefore intended that the appended claims cover all such changes and modifications that are within the scope of the embodiments shown and described herein.

[0082] It should be understood that these embodiments are merely exemplary and are not intended to limit the scope of this disclosure.

Claims

- 1.** A light emitting diode, comprising: a first conductivity type semiconductor layer; a V-pit generation layer disposed on the first conductivity type semiconductor layer and having a first V-pit of a first inlet width; a stress relief layer disposed on the V-pit generation layer and providing a second V-pit of a second inlet width greater than the first inlet width of the first V-pit; an active layer disposed on the stress relief layer and including a first active layer region formed on a flat surface of the stress relief layer and a second active layer region formed in the second V-pit; and a second conductivity type semiconductor layer disposed on the active layer, wherein light emitted through the first conductivity type semiconductor layer or the second conductivity type semiconductor layer is white light.
 - 2.** The light emitting diode of claim 1, wherein the stress relief layer includes an $\text{In}_{0.5}\text{Al}_{0.5}\text{Ga}_{0.1-0.5}\text{N}$ layer ($0 < x < 1$, $0 \leq y < 1$), and an average lattice constant of the stress relief layer is greater than an average lattice constant of the V-pit generation layer and smaller than an average lattice constant of the active layer.
 - 3.** The light emitting diode of claim 2, wherein the stress relief layer includes a plurality of pairs of different nitride semiconductor layers.
 - 4.** The light emitting diode of claim 3, wherein the stress relief layer has a stacked structure in which a first nitride semiconductor layer and a second nitride semiconductor layer are alternately disposed, the first and the second nitride semiconductor layers having different band gap energies.
 - 5.** The light emitting diode of claim 3, wherein the stress relief layer includes a superlattice layer.
 - 6.** The light emitting diode of claim 3, wherein a number of pairs of the plurality of different nitride semiconductor layers included in the stress relief layer is greater than a number of pairs of a barrier layer and a well layer included in the active layer.
 - 7.** The light emitting diode of claim 1, further comprising: a gap layer disposed between the stress relief layer and the active layer, wherein the gap layer has a lattice constant smaller than an average lattice constant of the stress relief layer and an average lattice constant of the active layer.
 - 8.** A light emitting diode, comprising: a first conductivity type semiconductor layer; a V-pit generation layer having V-pits; a stress relief layer disposed on the V-pit generation layer; an active layer disposed on the stress relief layer; and a second conductivity type semiconductor layer disposed on the active layer, wherein: the light emitting diode emits light of a multi-band spectrum of a shorter wavelength band and a longer wavelength band, and under an operating current, an intensity of light of the shorter wavelength band is higher than an intensity of light of the longer wavelength band.
 - 9.** The light emitting diode of claim 8, wherein the intensity of light in the shorter wavelength band is two or more times higher than the intensity of light in the longer wavelength band.
 - 10.** The light emitting diode of claim 8, wherein: the second conductivity type semiconductor layer has a plurality of concave grooves formed on a surface thereof, and at least one of the concave grooves has an inlet width greater than 400 nm.
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